

FAMILY MEETING TOOLKIT

Agenda Templates, Discussion Cards & Decision-Making Tools

By Daniel Tesfamariam

WHY FAMILY MEETINGS WORK

Regular family meetings teach kids: democracy, problem-solving, communication, and that their voice matters.

- Reduces daily nagging (decisions made together stick)
- Kids feel heard and respected
- Problems get solved before they explode
- Builds teamwork and family identity
- Teaches real-world meeting and negotiation skills

FAMILY MEETING GROUND RULES

Post these where everyone can see:

1. Everyone gets a turn to talk
2. Listen without interrupting
3. No blaming or name-calling
4. Focus on solutions, not problems
5. Decisions need agreement (not just parent vote)
6. Meeting lasts 15-30 minutes max
7. End with something fun (game, treat, activity)

WEEKLY MEETING AGENDA TEMPLATE

Date: ___/___/___ Time: ___:___ Facilitator: _____

1. OPENING (2 min)

Appreciation round - each person compliments another family member

2. REVIEW LAST WEEK (3 min)

Did we follow through on decisions? ☐ Yes ☐ Partially ☐ No

What worked? _____

What didn't? _____

3. NEW BUSINESS (10-15 min)

Issue 1: _____

Solutions brainstormed: _____

Decision: _____

Who will do what by when? _____

Issue 2: _____

Solutions brainstormed: _____

Decision: _____

4. CALENDAR CHECK (3 min)

Upcoming events: _____

5. FUN ACTIVITY (5+ min)

This week: _____

DISCUSSION CARDS (Cut Out & Use)

Pull one card each meeting for bonus discussion:

1. What's one rule that needs changing? Why?
2. What's the best thing about our family?
3. Is anyone feeling overwhelmed this week?
4. What chore system is working/not working?
5. What should we do for fun this weekend?
6. Is anyone having trouble with a friend?
7. What meal should we cook together this week?
8. What's something we could do for our community?
9. Is screen time working fairly for everyone?
10. What are we looking forward to this month?
11. Does anyone need help with something?
12. How can we be kinder to each other this week?

FAMILY DECISION-MAKING TOOLS

Method 1: Thumbs Vote

Thumbs up = love it | Sideways = okay with it | Down = can't live with it

Need: No thumbs down to proceed

Method 2: Pros and Cons List

Option: _____

PROS: _____ | _____ | _____ | _____

CONS: _____ | _____ | _____ | _____

Method 3: Trial Period

We'll try [decision] for ____ week(s) and review at next meeting.

Method 4: Rotate Choice

This week [name] chooses. Next week [name] chooses.

FAMILY MEETING TRACKER

Keep a record of decisions made:

Meeting #1 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #2 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #3 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #4 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #5 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #6 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #7 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion

Meeting #8 Date: ____/____/____

Decision: _____

Follow-up: ☐ Done ☐ In progress ☐ Needs discussion